



Spin surge: Maxwell Swaminathan, the off-spin all-rounder from Ghatkopar, stood out with eight wickets in six T20 Mumbai League games. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

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Local leagues, **real moments** — our team brings you both the action and what surrounds it.

The T20 Mumbai League returned after six years amid uncertainty. The build-up was shaky too, with the start delayed by a week due to the IPL, followed by torrential rain.

Yet, once the action began, it proved to be a vital platform for local

cricketers to showcase their talent. Rain did interrupt play, but it didn't dampen the players' drive. Many pushed hard to impress IPL scouts, who were watching closely.

"Such tournaments always encourage players like us to prove our mettle and since they are broadcast live, it comes as a double

motivation," said Sairaj Patil, one of Eagle Thane Strikers' top scorers. Patil, a domestic regular for Mumbai, has shared dressing rooms with top players. But for many, this was a rare opportunity.

"Leading up to the tournament, we got to spend a day with Kapil Dev and pick his brains. For the team, it was a huge opportunity to interact with the legend and get his suggestions," said SoBo Falcons' vice-captain Angkrish Raghuvanshi. His team, led by Shreyas Iyer,